STARGATE KOREA / DIGITAL GUIDE 01

Seoul, at your own *pace.*

A practical first-trip guide

1, 3 & 5 days / English edition / November 2026



Routes, arrival decisions, booking checks & planning pages

Find your starting point.

PLAN THE TRIP	PAGE
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If you only read three pages

Read page 4 to settle the important decisions, page 10 to sketch a first full day and page 24 before leaving the hotel. A short plan you can actually use is better than a list you spend the whole trip chasing.

Free online route selector and current site notes

Land. Connect. Reach your base.

After a flight, a simple route is often the most useful route. Compare the whole journey to your property, including transfers, luggage and the final walk, rather than choosing only by the airport leg.

OPTION	WHAT TO CHECK
Airport rail	Correct terminal, destination station, current service hours, ticket type and your onward connection.
Airport bus	Current route and stop, luggage conditions, ticketing and traffic-sensitive travel time.
Taxi or vehicle	Official pickup arrangements, the fare basis, your party's luggage needs and the complete destination address.

Have a second route

If your flight is delayed, check again before purchasing a ticket. A connection that worked for the scheduled landing time may no longer work. Use current airport and operator information, and ask at an official information point when uncertain.

Keep arrival evening light. Check in, find a nearby meal and locate the station or stop you will use the next morning. Your first full day will be easier for it.

Incheon Airport: official train information

Palace mornings. Tea afternoons.

ANCHOR AREA: JONGNO / ANGUK

Gyeongbokgung - Insadong - Ikseon-dong

Begin with the palace after checking its current opening calendar. Give the visit enough space to look around rather than treating it as a quick photograph before the next stop.

Move toward Insadong for a slower middle part of the day. Tea, craft shops or a meal can be the point of the afternoon, not merely a break between attractions. Choose the places that interest you rather than trying to visit every lane.

If you still want another stop, explore around Ikseon-dong. Otherwise, finish after Insadong. A day with two well-chosen areas can feel fuller than one with an extra rushed neighborhood.

Make it fit

- Slow version: keep the palace and Insadong. Leave the last stop optional.
- Rain version: choose an indoor cultural stop and a longer tea break, after checking current access.
- Before leaving: confirm the palace calendar, the route between stops and the way back to your base.

Visit Seoul: Insadong neighborhood information

Plan the total.
Keep a little room.

Use your actual quotes and chosen currency. This is a planning sheet, not a forecast of Seoul prices. Separate fixed bookings from daily choices and leave a reserve for changes.

CATEGORY	PLANNED	ACTUAL
Accommodation / complete stay	_____	_____
Airport journeys / both ways	_____	_____
Local transport / all days	_____	_____
Meals and cafe stops	_____	_____
Tickets, classes and activities	_____	_____
Connectivity	_____	_____
Shopping and personal items	_____	_____
Reserve for changes	_____	_____
TOTAL / currency: _____	_____	_____

Compare before confirming

Check taxes, guest count, included items and cancellation costs. Record payments in one currency for comparison, but keep the provider's original amount and currency with your confirmation. Exchange rates and provider charges can change.

Check the details where they belong.

Source links were reviewed for this edition on November 12, 2026. Use the live pages for current conditions. Most recommendations in this book are original editorial planning suggestions; the links below support destination and operator checks.

Visit Seoul / official destination guide

Start here for current neighborhood, transport, visitor and accessible-travel resources.

Visit Seoul / accommodation

Visit Seoul / Gwangjang Market

Visit Seoul / Insadong course

Incheon Airport / train information

KT / visitor connectivity

National Museum of Korea / visitor information

VISITKOREA / Bukchon

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